

Habitat and Its Components

Every habitat is a mix of living things and non-living surroundings that together let organisms survive.

Living and non-living parts

A **habitat** is the place where an organism lives (a pond, a forest, even a tree's bark). Every habitat has two kinds of components.

Biotic components	Abiotic components
Living things — plants, animals, microbes	Non-living things — air, water, sunlight, soil, temperature
Fish, frogs, algae, lotus	Water, soil, oxygen, sunlight

Survival needs: a pond gives a fish its **biotic** needs (food from small plants/animals) and its **abiotic** needs (oxygen from water, space, shelter).

Different organisms, same habitat

Organisms in one habitat may use resources differently. A snake active at night and a rodent active by day share the same forest but face different conditions — this is how they **coexist in harmony**.

Remember: "biotic = alive", "abiotic = not alive". Both are needed for life in a habitat.

Where students lose marks

Trap 1 — Biotic = living, abiotic = non-living. Soil, water, air and sunlight are abiotic; plants, animals and microbes are biotic.

Trap 2 — A habitat needs both. Living things depend on non-living surroundings to survive.

Trap 3 — A dead leaf or bark can be a habitat too — habitat just means where an organism lives.

Model answers — write them like this

Example A. Classify as biotic or abiotic: fish, water, lotus, soil.

Step 1: Living → biotic; non-living → abiotic.

∴ Biotic: fish, lotus. Abiotic: water, soil.

Example B. Name one biotic and one abiotic need a fish gets from a pond.

Step 1: Biotic need = food from small plants/animals.

Step 2: Abiotic need = oxygen (and water/space).

∴ Biotic: food; Abiotic: oxygen.

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